



School of MSB

Name of the faculty member: Dr.Monalisha Patel

Course Code: HRM 204	Course Title: Compensation Management
Academic Task No: 2	Academic Task Title: Assignment (Group)
Date of Allotment: 17 /04/2026	Date of Submission: 01/05/2026
Student Roll No: 19	Student Reg. No: 12321934
Term: 6	Section: 20M95
Max. Marks : 30	Marks. Obtained:
Evaluation Parameters	

Evaluator's Signature and Date

Peer Rating Table

Sr. No	Registration No.	Name of the Student	Roll No.	Peer Rating	Student's Signature
1	12321380	Vikash Gupta	11	10	
2	12321429	Yoga Nand Roy	12	9	
3	12321475	Harshit Kumar	13	7	
4	12321720	Mohd. Ahmad	15	10	
5	12321934	Nirbhay Kumar	10	10	

Declaration:

We, Nirbhay Kumar (Reg. No. 12321934) and team members, declare that this assignment is our group work. We have not copied it from any other students' work or from any other source except where due acknowledgement is made explicitly in the text, nor has any part been written for us by any other person.

Name of the Project:- **RewardIQ — AI-Powered Compensation Intelligence Platform (HRM204 Prototype)**

Platform Artefact: RewardIQ_v8.0 — Power BI-Based HR Analytics Prototype

Objective: What is the purpose of this project and what did you aim to build and demonstrate?

The primary objective of this project is to design, develop, and critically evaluate RewardIQ — a data-driven compensation and reward intelligence platform built for HR teams in contemporary organizations. Developed as part of the HRM 204 Compensation Management course at Lovely Professional University, this platform demonstrates how data analytics and Power BI dashboards can transform the way organizations plan, distribute, and communicate employee rewards. The project bridges academic theory on compensation management with a working analytics prototype, showing how reward classification, performance analytics, and predictive insights can be consolidated into a single, accessible HR dashboard.

This exercise is part of the HRM204 – Compensation Management course at Lovely Professional University and is designed to bridge academic theory with real-world HR practice. The analysis focuses on key dimensions including financial compensation, non-monetary recognition, statutory benefits, appraisal transparency, and overall employee satisfaction with the reward system.

.

QUESTION 1: PROJECT OVERVIEW AND TECHNOLOGY ANALYSIS

1.1 What is RewardIQ?

RewardIQ is a Power BI-based HR analytics prototype that addresses one of the most persistent challenges in people management: the absence of structured, data-driven decision support for compensation and reward planning. In most organizations — particularly mid-sized manufacturing firms, BPO units, and retail chains — bonus decisions are made through manual manager reviews, subjective impressions, or scattered spreadsheet models. These approaches are slow, inconsistent, and difficult to audit.

RewardIQ centralizes employee performance data into a single interactive

Power BI dashboard. The system evaluates each employee across four dimensions — Performance Score, Attendance Score, Feedback Score, and Productivity Score — and uses data-driven calculations to classify them into reward tiers: Gold, Silver, Bronze, or Under Review. HR administrators gain a comprehensive analytics dashboard, while employees can view their performance metrics, compare themselves with department peers, and understand how changes in behaviour might affect their reward outcome.

1.2 Target User Groups and System Workflow

RewardIQ serves multiple user groups, each with a tailored analytical view. HR Administrators have access to company-wide KPIs, tier distribution analytics, department averages, top performer lists, and an employee directory with advanced filters, all presented through interactive Power BI dashboards. Employees can view personalized reports showing reward score, bonus, points, department rank, leaderboard position, and a detailed performance breakdown through visual charts. Managers can analyze different scenarios using data filters and comparative visuals to understand how performance impacts reward outcomes. Academic Evaluators benefit from a prototype that combines a polished dashboard interface with practical data analytics, making it ideal for HRM coursework demonstrations.

The system follows a simplified data analytics architecture using Power BI. The dataset is imported from CSV files and transformed using Power Query for cleaning and structuring. Data modeling is performed within Power BI, where relationships are established between tables and DAX (Data Analysis Expressions) is used to create calculated measures such as reward score, rankings, and tier classifications. Interactive visuals such as bar charts, pie charts, and KPI cards are used to display insights in real time. Users can apply filters and slicers to explore data dynamically without requiring backend processing or APIs.

RewardIQ was built with a deliberate emphasis on simplicity, accessibility, and practical usability. The technology choice of Power BI ensures that the platform is easy to deploy, requires no coding environment setup, and can run on any system with Power BI Desktop or Service. This makes it highly suitable for academic demonstrations while still delivering professional-quality analytics and visualization capabilities.

Layer	Technology	Role in RewardIQ
Frontend	Power BI Dashboard (Desktop + Service)	Interactive dashboards with real-time visuals, slicers, and KPI cards — no coding required
Backend	Power BI Data Model + DAX	Data processing, calculations, and business logic handled through DAX measures and relationships
ML Engine	Power BI Analytics (DAX + Conditional Logic)	Reward tier classification based on performance metrics using calculated measures

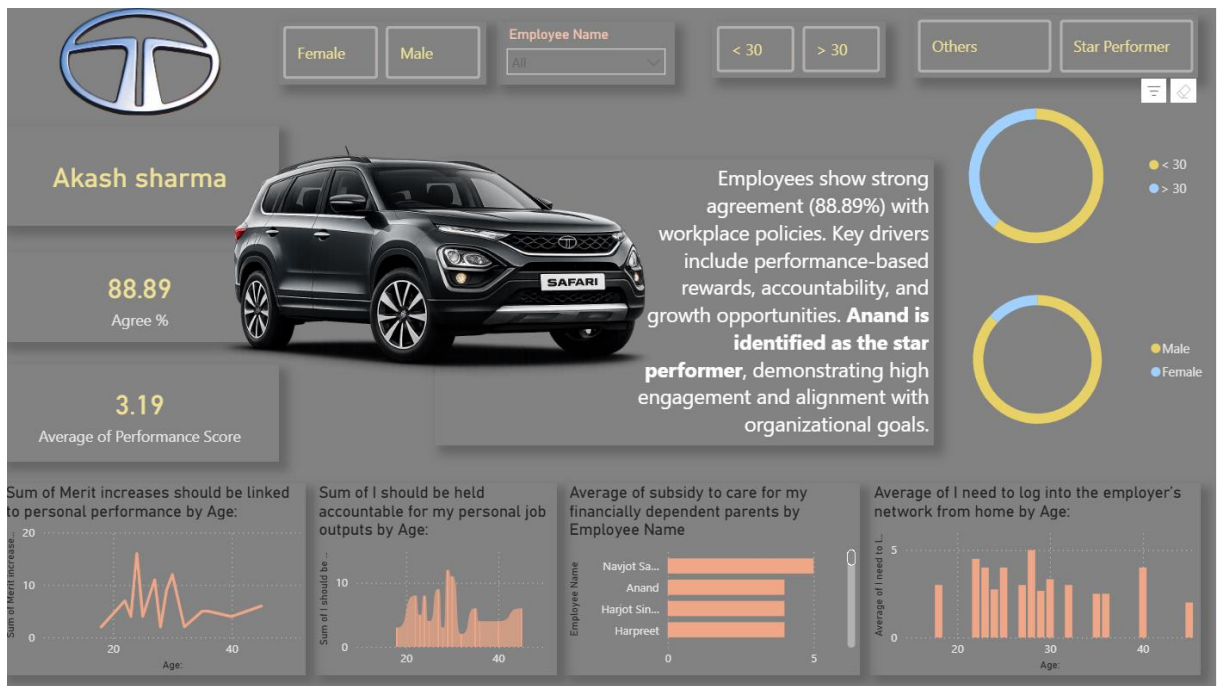
Layer	Technology	Role in RewardIQ
Data Layer	Power Query + CSV / Excel	Data cleaning, transformation, and loading into Power BI model
Typography	Default Power BI Themes / Custom Theme	Clean and professional dashboard design
Visualization	Power BI Visuals (Bar, Pie, Line, KPI Cards, Slicers)	Interactive charts and insights for HR analytics

1.3 Architecture Overview

The architecture follows a Power BI-based analytics model, where the system is designed as a centralized data visualization platform rather than a client-server application. The dataset is imported from CSV/Excel files and processed using Power Query for data cleaning and transformation. The transformed data is then loaded into the Power BI data model, where relationships between tables are established.

All data processing and business logic are handled within Power BI using DAX (Data Analysis Expressions). Measures are created to calculate reward scores, rankings, and tier classifications (Gold, Silver, Bronze, Under Review) based on employee performance metrics. The system does not rely on APIs or backend services; instead, it uses an in-memory data model that enables fast and efficient analytics.

Interactive dashboards are built using Power BI visuals such as bar charts, pie charts, KPI cards, and slicers. Users can dynamically filter and explore data by department, employee, or performance criteria. This architecture ensures simplicity, ease of deployment, and accessibility, making it highly suitable for academic and analytical use cases without requiring complex infrastructure.

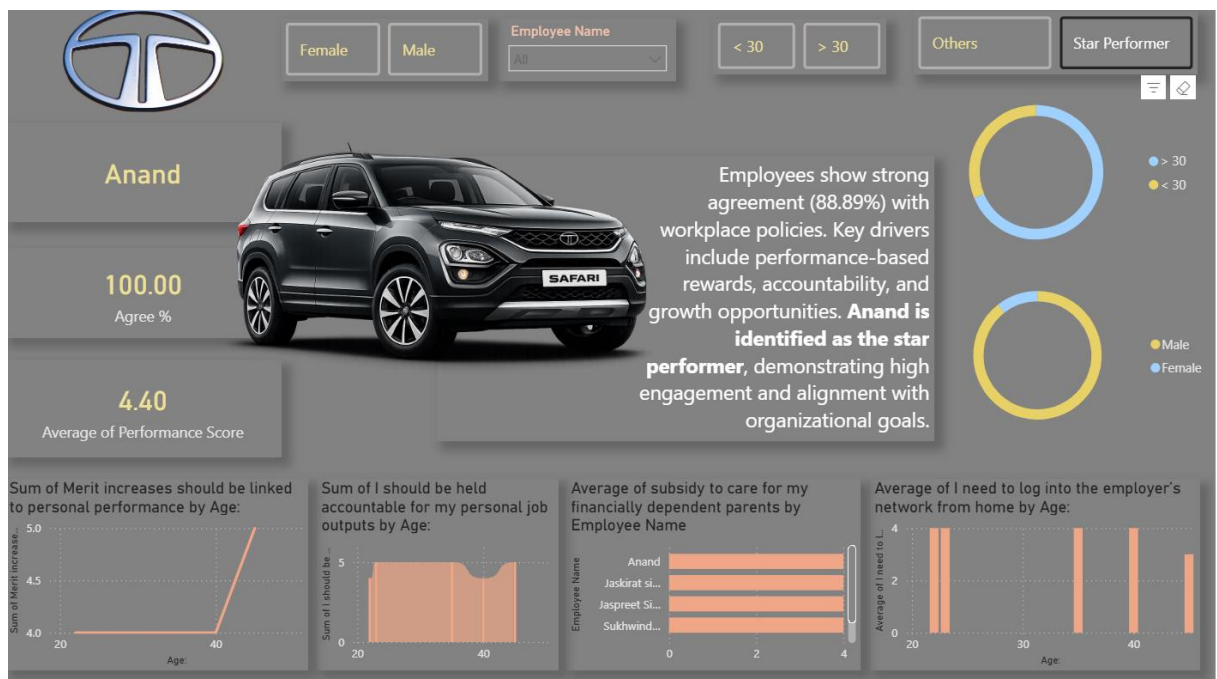


1.4 Employee Dataset Profile

The underlying dataset contains **20 employees** across six departments — Administration, Engineering, Factory Floor, Human Resources, Loom Operations, and Quality Control — with 32 data columns per employee. The dataset is imported and processed using Power BI through CSV/Excel sources.

The current reward tier distribution shows Bronze, Silver, Gold, and Under Review employees across different departments. The overall average reward score is calculated based on employee performance metrics.

This diversity across departments, experience levels, and reward tiers makes the dataset suitable for demonstrating Power BI’s analytical and visualization capabilities. The data is transformed using Power Query and analyzed using DAX measures to generate meaningful insights and dashboards.



Reward Tier Distribution of Platform Dataset

Reward Tier	Employees	Bonus (Rs.)	Percentage
Bronze Tier	9	46.7%	Rs. 6,000
Silver Tier	7	30%	Rs. 11,000
Gold Tier	3	13.3%	Rs. 18,000

QUESTION 2: FEATURES, DASHBOARDS, AND DATA ANALYSIS

This section presents a detailed examination of RewardIQ's key features, dashboard modules, and the analytics generated using Power BI. The analysis covers four areas: the Employee Dashboard experience, the Department Leaderboard, the Admin Workforce Dashboard, and the Employee Directory with advanced filtering. Each module is described with reference to its HR relevance and the specific business value it delivers, summarized below, incorporating both quantitative insights and visual analytics generated through the platform.

1.5 Employee Dashboard Features

The employee-facing dashboard is designed around the principle of transparent self-awareness — giving workers clear visibility into how their performance translates into reward outcomes. In the Power BI dashboard, the employee view presents key details such

as name, department, experience, and overall performance summary.

Five KPI cards are displayed at the top of the dashboard, each with clear visual indicators: Reward Score, Performance, Attendance, Feedback, and Bonus with reward points. These visuals help employees easily understand their performance metrics and how they impact their reward classification.

The Analytics section provides a side-by-side comparison of the employee's scores against department averages, displayed using interactive bar charts in Power BI. This "You vs Department" visual is particularly meaningful from an HR perspective — it allows employees to identify specific dimensions where they lag behind peers and focus on improvement accordingly.

The Score Breakdown panel further supports this by presenting individual visual indicators for Performance, Attendance, Feedback, and Productivity, helping users clearly understand their strengths and areas that need improvement.

The department-wise performance analysis is visualized using Power BI, showing average scores, top-performing tiers, and key observations for each department. The analysis highlights variations in performance across departments, helping HR identify strengths and areas of improvement.

Engineering shows the highest average score, indicating strong performance driven by skill-based roles. Human Resources also performs well, supported by strong feedback scores. Administration and Quality Control maintain moderate and consistent performance levels.

On the other hand, Factory Floor and Loom Operations show comparatively lower average scores, mainly due to lower attendance and feedback metrics. Loom Operations also has the highest number of employees under the "Under Review" category, indicating the need for targeted HR intervention.

Overall, this analysis helps in understanding department-wise performance trends and supports data-driven decision-making for reward distribution and employee development.

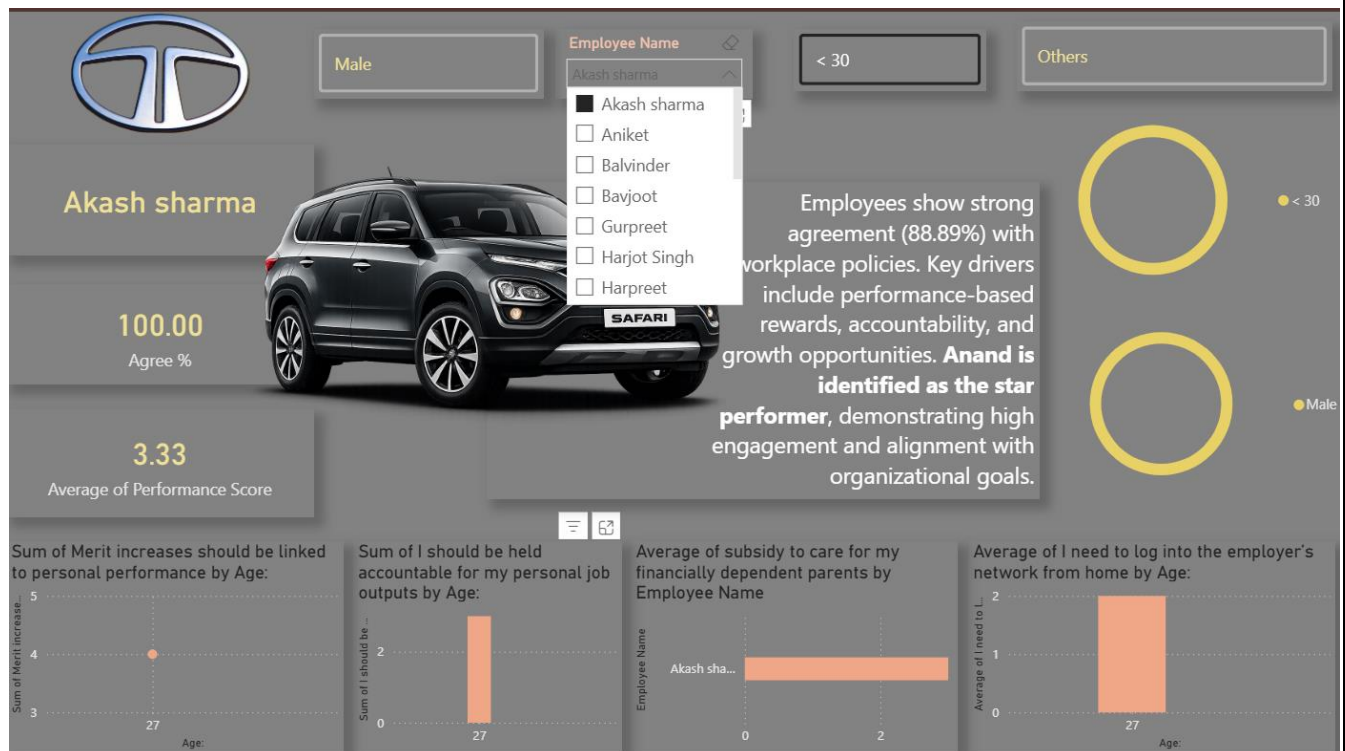
Overall Average Reward Score (all departments, 30 employees): 3.28 / 5.00

1.6 Department Leaderboard and Competitive Visibility

The Leaderboard view displays employees within the same department, ranked based on their reward score using Power BI visuals. The selected employee can be highlighted through filters or slicers, making it easy to understand their position relative to others. Reward tiers — Gold, Silver, Bronze, and Under Review — are clearly indicated alongside each employee's score, providing quick visual insight.

This feature supports a key objective of modern reward management systems: promoting

healthy and transparent competition. By visualizing rankings and performance comparisons, employees can clearly see where they stand among their peers, making reward outcomes feel more fair and performance based. The leaderboard transforms the reward system into a continuous and visible process that encourages ongoing improvement rather than a one-time evaluation.



1.7 Admin Dashboard and Workforce Analytics

The admin dashboard in Power BI provides a comprehensive view focused on organizational insights rather than individual performance. It presents key company-level metrics such as total employees, overall budget, average reward score, and number of departments through summary KPI cards. This helps HR quickly understand the overall workforce performance.

Additional KPI visuals display the count of employees in each reward tier — Gold, Silver, Bronze, and Under Review — along with the total budget allocation.

Visualizations such as a Tier Distribution donut chart and a department-wise average score bar chart provide clear insights into the reward structure. The donut chart shows the distribution of employees across different reward tiers, while the department-wise chart helps identify high-performing and low-performing departments.

These insights enable HR teams to make data-driven decisions, identify areas that require improvement, and plan effective reward and performance management strategies.

1.8 Employee Directory and Data Analytics Generated

The Directory view presents all **20 employees** in a searchable and filterable table within Power BI. Columns include ID, Name, Department, Gender, Performance, Attendance, Feedback, Score, Tier, and Bonus. HR administrators can filter data by department, reward tier, and gender using slicers, or quickly locate specific employees using search functionality. This replaces the traditional practice of manually scrolling through spreadsheets and significantly improves day-to-day HR workflow efficiency.

The system generates multiple categories of analytics, including company-wide KPIs, department-wise average comparisons, top performer identification, gender-based performance insights, and score distribution visuals. Power BI further enables advanced analysis through interactive dashboards, allowing HR teams to explore data trends, compare metrics, and derive meaningful insights without requiring coding expertise.

QUESTION 3: HR RELEVANCE, STRENGTHS, AND IMPROVEMENT ROADMAP

RewardIQ is directly aligned with the core objectives of contemporary compensation management practice, operationalising three foundational HR principles: performance transparency, reward equity, and data-driven decision-making. Using Power BI, employee performance tracking is carried out across five dimensions — Performance Score, Attendance Score, Feedback Score, Productivity Score, and the composite Reward Score — providing a multi-dimensional view that avoids the single-metric limitation of traditional appraisal systems.

The reward and recognition framework maps these scores into Gold, Silver, Bronze, or Under Review tiers — each with a corresponding bonus amount and reward points. Gold performers receive Rs. 15,000; Silver performers receive Rs. 10,000; Bronze performers receive Rs. 5,000; and Under Review employees are flagged for HR attention. This structured, data-driven classification within Power BI dashboards replaces subjective decision-making with a consistent and transparent process that employees can clearly understand and work towards.

Platform Evaluation: Feature Analysis by Module

Evaluation Dimension	Rating	Remarks
Technology Stack & Architecture	7 / 10	Power BI-based architecture with data modeling, Power Query, and DAX provides a clean and efficient analytics solution for an HR prototype. Scalability may require integration with databases or cloud services.
UI/UX Design & User Experience	8 / 10	Clean and interactive Power BI dashboard with KPI cards, slicers, and dynamic visuals provides a strong user experience and easy navigation.

Evaluation Dimension	Rating	Remarks
HR & Business Value	8.5 / 10	Addresses a real compensation challenge. Gold/Silver/Bronze reward tiers, interactive dashboards, and data-driven insights in Power BI provide strong HR value.
Production Readiness	4 / 10	Suitable for analytical and academic use. However, enterprise deployment may require integration with live databases, automated data refresh, and security controls.
Overall Assessment	7.2 / 10	A well-designed Power BI-based HR analytics prototype that demonstrates strong business value and visualization capability, with scope for enhancement toward enterprise-level implementation.

Key Strength 1 – Clean and Structured Data Architecture:

RewardIQ's key strength lies in its clean and structured Power BI data model. Data is transformed using Power Query and organized through relationships, while DAX measures handle all calculations and business logic. This approach ensures that data processing and visualization are clearly separated, making the system easy to maintain, modify, and understand.

Key Strength 2 – Integrated Analytics and Interactive Insights:

From an HR and business perspective, the platform effectively combines employee performance analytics, reward tier classification, and interactive dashboards into a single experience. Power BI enables users to explore different scenarios using filters and slicers, helping them understand how performance impacts rewards. This transforms the reward system into a more transparent and insight-driven process.

Key Limitation 1 – No Live Database Integration:

The platform relies on CSV/Excel-based data sources within Power BI, which are suitable for a small dataset but not ideal for real-world enterprise use. For scalability, integration with live databases such as SQL Server or cloud-based data sources would be required. Additionally, manual data updates may be needed if automatic refresh is not configured.

Key Limitation 2 – Limited Security and Access Control:

Since the project is built as a Power BI prototype, advanced security features such as role-based access control, data-level security, and user authentication are limited. For real-world deployment, features like Row-Level Security (RLS), secure data sharing, and controlled

access permissions would need to be implemented.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

This assignment provided one of the most integrated learning experiences across the HRM 204 curriculum — combining theoretical compensation management concepts with hands-on data analysis, dashboard design, and critical evaluation using Power BI. Designing and analyzing RewardIQ highlighted that an effective reward system must address the full spectrum of employee motivational needs: from fair compensation and statutory compliance to recognition, transparency, and perceived organisational fairness.

The development process showed that HR analytics is not just about visualizing data, but about making meaningful decisions. Every choice — such as selecting performance metrics, defining weightage, designing dashboards, and deciding what insights to present — has a direct impact on people management. Creating the reward tier classification (Gold, Silver, Bronze, Under Review) required careful consideration to ensure fairness across departments and employee roles.

Analyzing the system also revealed challenges in data-driven compensation management. While Power BI enables efficient analysis and visualization, over-reliance on data can sometimes overlook human judgment and contextual factors. This reinforced the understanding that data analytics in HR should support decision-making, not replace it.

The evaluation framework applied in this project — considering technology, design, business value, and practical usability — provided a structured approach to assess HR analytics tools. It helped in understanding that a system can be strong in design and insights but still require improvements for real-world implementation.

Finally, comparing different industry contexts highlighted that there is no one-size-fits-all compensation strategy. Each organisation requires a customized reward system based on its workforce, industry standards, and organisational culture. This project helped in developing the ability to align HR practices with real-world business needs.

Suggestions and Recommendations:

1. Introduce Formal Non-Monetary Recognition Programs:

RewardIQ can be enhanced by incorporating a structured non-monetary recognition system within the Power BI dashboard. This can include features such as “Employee of the Quarter” recognition, digital badges, and milestone-based achievements (e.g., 5, 10, and 15 years of service), visualized through dedicated dashboard sections.

Such recognition programs play a crucial role in improving employee motivation and engagement, often delivering a stronger long-term impact than financial incentives alone.

Integrating these elements into the analytics platform would help create a more balanced and comprehensive reward system, addressing an important gap in the current prototype.

2. Establish Reward Approval Workflows:

Before finalizing any reward tier classification, a structured approval workflow should be introduced. In the Power BI-based system, the calculated reward tier should act as an initial recommendation, while managers review and validate the final decision externally or through integrated tools.

Managers should have the ability to adjust reward tiers with proper justification, ensuring fairness and incorporating human judgment into the process. This approach adds transparency, reduces bias, and helps maintain accountability by creating a clear review and approval mechanism for reward decisions.

3. Implement Bias and Fairness Monitoring:

The analytics layer can be enhanced in Power BI by incorporating fairness monitoring dashboards. These can include gender-based tier distribution, experience-level comparisons, and department-wise performance analysis. If the data shows consistent disparities — such as a specific department having more employees in lower tiers — HR should investigate whether the evaluation metrics or data inputs are biased. This ensures fairness and promotes trust in the reward system.

4. Deploy a Skill-Based Pay Supplement Module:

As organizations become more technology-driven, employees who acquire new skills — such as ERP systems, data analysis, or digital tools — can be recognized through additional incentives. In Power BI, this can be reflected by adding skill-based metrics into the reward calculation model. This encourages continuous learning and positions the system as a growth and development tool rather than just a performance evaluation system.

5. Conduct Periodic Compensation Benchmarking:

The platform can support periodic compensation benchmarking by analyzing external salary data alongside internal datasets within Power BI. By comparing compensation structures with industry standards, organizations can identify gaps and adjust their reward strategies accordingly. This helps in retaining talent and ensures that employees are compensated fairly in line with market trends.